

IN MAY 2026, Wockhardt's antibiotic Zaynich became the first novel molecule discovered, developed and owned entirely by an Indian firm to receive US FDA approval. For an industry that built its global reputation on generics and biosimilars, it was a historic moment. But Habil Khorakiwala, who bankrolled this 25-year programme, knows the harder part is still ahead.

After all, he has just seen the company through one of its toughest periods. Wockhardt returned to profitability in FY26 after years of losses. Debt has been pared down from ₹3,213 crore in FY20 to ₹1,859 crore in FY25. The base business—formulations, insulin and UK operations—is stable and growing. Can Zaynich, a novel antibiotic approved for complicated urinary tract infections and designed to tackle multidrug-resistant Gram-negative bacterial infections, be the drug that drives Wockhardt well into the future. Can it justify two decades of investment and make Wockhardt's turnaround sustainable?

The management has pegged peak annual sales potential at \$1.5-2 billion. The global addressable market is \$7-9 billion. While these are significant, they are also—as the history of antibiotic launches will attest—numbers that have humbled companies far larger than Wockhardt.

A TOUGH BET

"Zaynich is the first drug from the Indian pharmaceutical industry

THE MARKET OPPORTUNITY

GLOBAL
ANTIBIOTICS
MARKET

\$53
BILLION+

ZAYNICH
ADDRESSABLE
MARKET

\$7-9
BILLION

PEAK
ANNUAL SALES
POTENTIAL

\$1.5-2
BILLION

WOCKHARDT IN NUMBERS

INVESTMENT IN
ANTIBIOTIC R&D

₹6,800
CRORE

DURATION OF THE
DISCOVERY PROGRAMME

25
YEARS

NOVEL ANTIBIOTIC
MOLECULES
DEVELOPED

6

FY26 NET
PROFIT

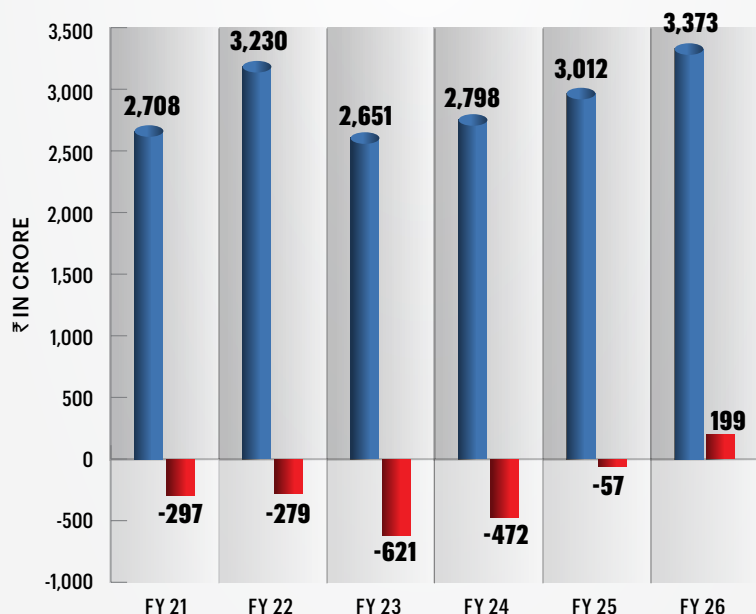
₹199
CRORE

CLINICAL SUCCESS
RATE IN PHASE 3 TRIAL

89
PER CENT

THE RECOVERY PATH

Wockhardt has managed to report its first profit after years of losses



■ GROSS SALES ■ PROFIT AFTER TAX

SOURCE ACE EQUITY